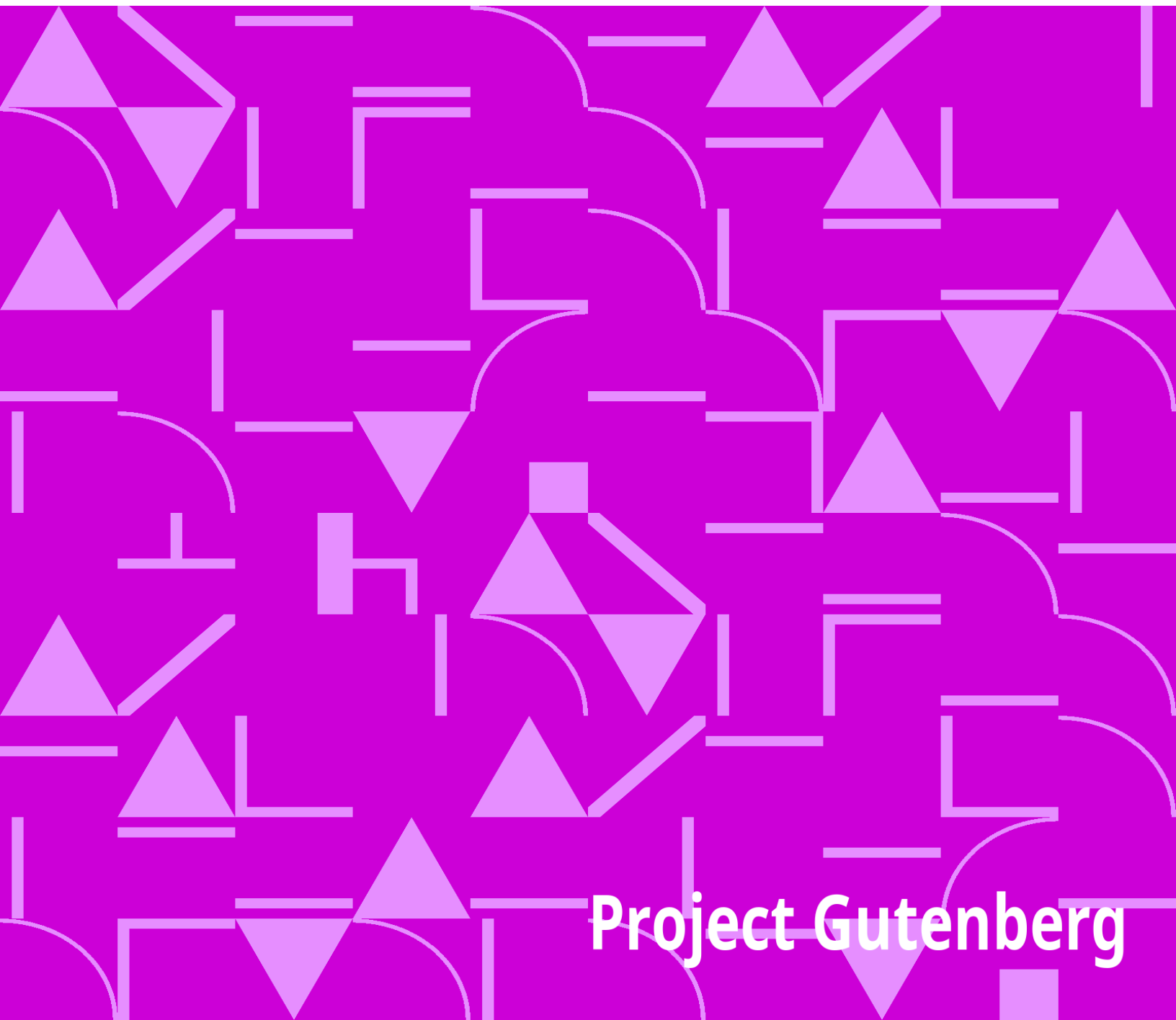


American Historical and Literary Curiosities, Part 16.

J. Jay Smith



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HISTORICAL AND LITERARY CURIOSITIES, PART 16. ***

**AMERICAN HISTORICAL
AND
LITERARY CURIOSITIES**

By John Jay Smith

Part 16.

Second Series

1860

AMERICAN
Historical and Literary Curiosities;
CONSISTING OF
Fac-Similes of some Plates, &c. Relating to
COLUMBUS,
AND
ORIGINAL DOCUMENTS of the REVOLUTION,
&c. &c.

WITH A VARIETY OF RELIQUES, ANTIQUITIES, AND AUTOGRAPHS.

EDITED AND ARRANGED,
WITH THE ASSISTANCE OF SEVERAL AUTOGRAPH COLLECTORS,

BY

JOHN JAY SMITH,
MEMBER OF THE HISTORICAL SOCIETY OF PENNSYLVANIA, ETC.

SECOND SERIES—COMPLETE IN ITSELF.

NEW YORK:
CHARLES B. RICHARDSON.
1860.

Enlarge

P R E F A C E.

THE First Series of "American Historical and Literary Curiosities," by John F. Watson, Esq. and myself, was commenced privately as a means of preserving many documents in the possession of our friends and ourselves; but they soon increased to such importance by contributions, that it was determined to publish them. Five editions were demanded by the public at home and abroad, and the work is now scarce and high-priced. The plates being worn out, no other edition of it is likely soon, if ever, to be issued.

This Second Series, complete in itself, owes its origin to the Commercial Panic, when it was desirable to employ several artists in want of work. It has been carried through by the assistance and contributions of various friends. I am particularly indebted to Ferdinand J. Dreer, Esq., Peter Force, Esq., Lewis J. Cist, Esq., Frank M. Etting, Esq., J. Wingate Thornton, Esq., Hon. George Folsom, Herman and Caleb Cope, Esqs., J. Francis Fisher, Esq., John Macalester, Esq., Charles J. Wister, Esq., Winthrop Sargent, Esq., Bushrod W. Adams, Esq. and others, and to the Philadelphia Library for the rare Broad-sides of the Revolution, and the Historical Society of Pennsylvania, whose valuable collections have been opened to my use in the handsomest and most liberal manner.

It may be proper to copy here a portion of the Preface to the fifth edition of the First Series, explanatory of the object of the work:—

"The past has a charm for Americans, as well as for the inhabitants of countries whose history extends far into the shadowy and unknown. *Our* early and romantic past has the merit of being known and truly related. Every thing which adds to these truths is sought for with avidity by the curious and intelligent inquirer. We have now many autograph-collectors, who may be viewed in the light of preservers of documents which would otherwise perish or be dispersed. To few, comparatively, are their treasures revealed. It was suggested, therefore, that some of the most rare 'Historical and Literary Curiosities' in the possession of individuals, should be grouped for the amusement and instruction of the present and of future generations, who may well know from printed accounts *what* things were done, but who can also thus learn *how* they were done."

As in the First Series, nearly all the articles in the present collection have been taken by competent artists from the originals of which they purport to be fac-similes. Considerable labor and trouble have been expended in collecting together and adapting the varied materials here presented, but I have been rewarded by the pleasure of the pursuit.

JOHN JAY SMITH.

* * Fully to understand the work, it is necessary, in turning over the pages, to have constant reference to the Tables of Contents, where will be found many explanations for which there was not space on the plates.

§§ 1

Original Volume 2, Part Six A

CONTENTS.—No. VI.

PLATES XXXIV. TO XLIV.

PLATE XXXIV.—1. Stephen Girard, sitting at his counting-house desk, as remembered by many still living. Scarcely in the least caricatured. *In possession of John McAllister, Jr.*

2. Characteristic Letter from Stephen Girard. *In possession of Ferdinand J. Dreer.*

PLATES XXXV., XXXVI., and XXXVII.—A Selection from the Social Notes to and from Mrs. Madison during her residence in Washington. These treasured notes, carefully preserved by the recipient, and generally with a copy of her reply, were bundled into a champagne-basket, and sold at auction for a mere trifle, after her decease, and are *in the possession of a distinguished Citizen.*

PLATE XXXVIII.—Curious Title-Pages of Books by Sir Walter Raleigh. *In possession of the Library Company of Philadelphia.*

PLATE XXXIX.—Fac-simile of a pure silver ornament for the head, presented by Charles the Second to "The Queene of Pamunkey." The Pamunkeys were a powerful Virginia tribe, whose remnants, now numbering about two hundred, occupy an island in the York River, Virginia, granted by Government. This curious relic is in possession of Arthur Moxson, Esq., of Richmond, Virginia, and has been kindly furnished by Thomas H. Wynn, of that city, who refers for additional particulars to Campbell's History of Virginia, page 95, and remarks that, "besides Pocahontas, this is the only Indian woman that I recollect as being of sufficient importance to be noticed by the historian of Virginia."

This ornament was no doubt given to conciliate the tribe. On the back are four rings soldered to the plate, evidently for the purpose of securing it to the head-dress.

PLATE XL.—1. Interesting Historical Letter from Thomas Jefferson. *In possession of Ferdinand J. Dreer.*

2. Note from General Montgomery. *In possession of the same.*

[Plate 34.](#)

[Plate 35.](#)

[Plate 36.](#)

[Plate 37.](#)

[Plate 38.](#)

[Plate](#)

[39.](#)

[Plate 40.](#)



Dear Sir

having perused your letter enclosed
for our President. I will sign the
recommendation which you propose after
you have obtained a few signatures

your mo: obedient
Stephⁿ Girard

Mr^r Will^m Israel

14th Feb^r 1809

Enlarge

I would afford no particular pleasure my dear Mrs. Linn to pass to-morrow evening with you but we were previously engaged at the President's to a party given the fair Brides among whose attendants is my niece.

Your affectionate friend
D. D. Madison.
June 10th 1842.

Mrs. Madison with the knowledge and approbation of the Secretary of State Mr. Buchanan a package directed to the Secretary of State at the Bureau of the War Office in the Post Office Building Dec 25 1846

Mrs. Madison against company
of Mrs. Madison evening 5. 1842.
M. S. Black.

Social Notes to & from Mrs. Madison, during her Residence in Washington.

The Sisters of the Visitation respectfully invite Mrs. Madison to attend the annual distribution of premiums at their Academy, July 1st at 10 o'clock Georgetown.

M^r Portier prie Madame Madison de lui faire l'honneur de passer la soirée chez lui Jeudi 28. Juin 1839

Mr. Webster asks the favor of Mrs. Madison's company at Breakfast, on Thursday, at 10 o'clock, President's Square, April 5. 1842.

Mrs. Madison has the pleasure to accept the invitation of Mr. & Mrs. Webster to dinner on Thursday next. March 5. 42.

Mr. Adams requests the pleasure of Mrs. Madison and Miss Payne's company on Thursday evening Feb. 5th at 8 1/2 o'clock. Thursday 29. Jan.

Enlarge

To Mrs E. A. Clark

Accept my best thanks dear Cousin for the highly valued lock of hair once worn by my Mother's friend — the lady whose name she gave me — I called to see you yesterday when I was charged with an invitation from my amiable neighbors Mrs. Ogle Taylor to your mother, myself and sweet sisters to visit her in a social way, the first evening you were here engaged bringing with you the Beards where society you prefer — I am interested in the acceptance of this invitation as I should have the pleasure then to meet you affectionately yours.
16th Feb 42

Mrs Madison's best respects to the President and would gladly take advantage of his polite invitation to witness the curious experiment of Mr. Bell but for a headache which would disqualify her from enjoying the noise — She hopes however that it will be pleasant and safe for the President and his daughter —

Aug. 20th 42.

Prof. Pagan regrets that it will not be in his power to accept the President's kind invitation for this evening — to witness the sublimation experiment.

I am proud of your invitation conveyed in such kind words, my dear Miss Van Delft, but a promise to Mrs Newman for this evening two days ago must delay my chance of finding you and yours in such social mood — which get the beams of our new moon still dance from wave to wave — I was not at the President's yesterday, having gone to dine with the Mayor & Lady — and the admiral's son — and his — whose visit to me this morn'g (how your affectionate friend protracted my evening) as you
March 16th 42.

I am greatly mortified my dear Cousin at not having the gratification of seeing you and your sweet daughter when you were so good as to call — Will you not console and indemnify me by coming to dine with us on Sat, bringing with you my natural friend your husband and your daughters, to whom I promise fine music.
Affectionately yours
D. P. Madison

Enlarge

C. Street
Monday Morn

My Dear Madam,

Mr. Frederick Peel,
a Son of Sir Robert,
desires to visit Mount
Abernon.

Will you do me the
favor to give him a
note, which will secure
him a favorable admis-
sion?

I hope to be able
to introduce Mr. Peel
to you personally before
he leaves the City.

Meantime, I am

With the greatest
respect,

Very faithfully,
Yours

Robt. C. Winthrop

Mr. Madison,

P. S. I had written & sent
a similar note to you this
morning, & the servant has
just now informed me
that it was mislaid.
This will explain the
matter, should you re-
ceive a duplicate.

Social Notes to & from Mrs Madison,
during her Residence in Washington.

(Copy)

You will permit me
dear Mrs Washington, to present
to you Mr. Frederick Peel, the
son of Sir Robert - a gentleman
well known & highly respected
by our Countrymen & all others
acquainted with his brilliant
character.

Mr. Peel desires to see
the home of your ancestor,
and perhaps to view the
tomb of "the Father of his Country".
Any civilities you may have
the goodness to show him to the
end, will greatly oblige
your friends of Washington.

Affectionately yours

July 3rd 48 (signed) D. D. Madison

Enclosed to the Hon. Robt. C. Winthrop
with Mrs Madison's best respects

Monsieur & Madame Calderon
de la Barca request the Honor of
Mrs Madison and Miss Haynes
Company on Wednesday Evg at
1/2 past 6 o'clock to be present at the
Baptism of Mr & Mrs Tacon's
baby.

Saturday 19th Jan'y

Enlarge

Pl. XXXVIII

NEVVES
Of Sr. Walter Rauleigh.

WITH
The true Description of G V I A N A :

As also a Relation of the excellent Gouernment, and
much hope of the prosperity of the Voyage.

*Sent from a Gentleman of his Fleet, to a most
especiall Friend of his in London.*

From the Riuer of Caliana, on the Coast of Guiana, Nouemb. 17. 1617.



L O N D O N.
Printed for H. C. and are to be sold by J. Wright, at the signe of the
Bible without New-gate. 1618.

The Cabinet-Council.
Containing the Cheif ARTS
OF
EMPIRE,
And MYSTERIES of
STATE;
DISCABINETED

In Political. and Polemical Aphorisms,
grounded on Authority, and Experience;
And illustrated with the choicest
Examples and Historical
Observations.

By the Ever-renowned Knight,
Sir WALTER RALEIGH,
Published
By JOHN MILTON, Esq;

Quis Martem iuxta rellum Admirationis digni scriptoris?

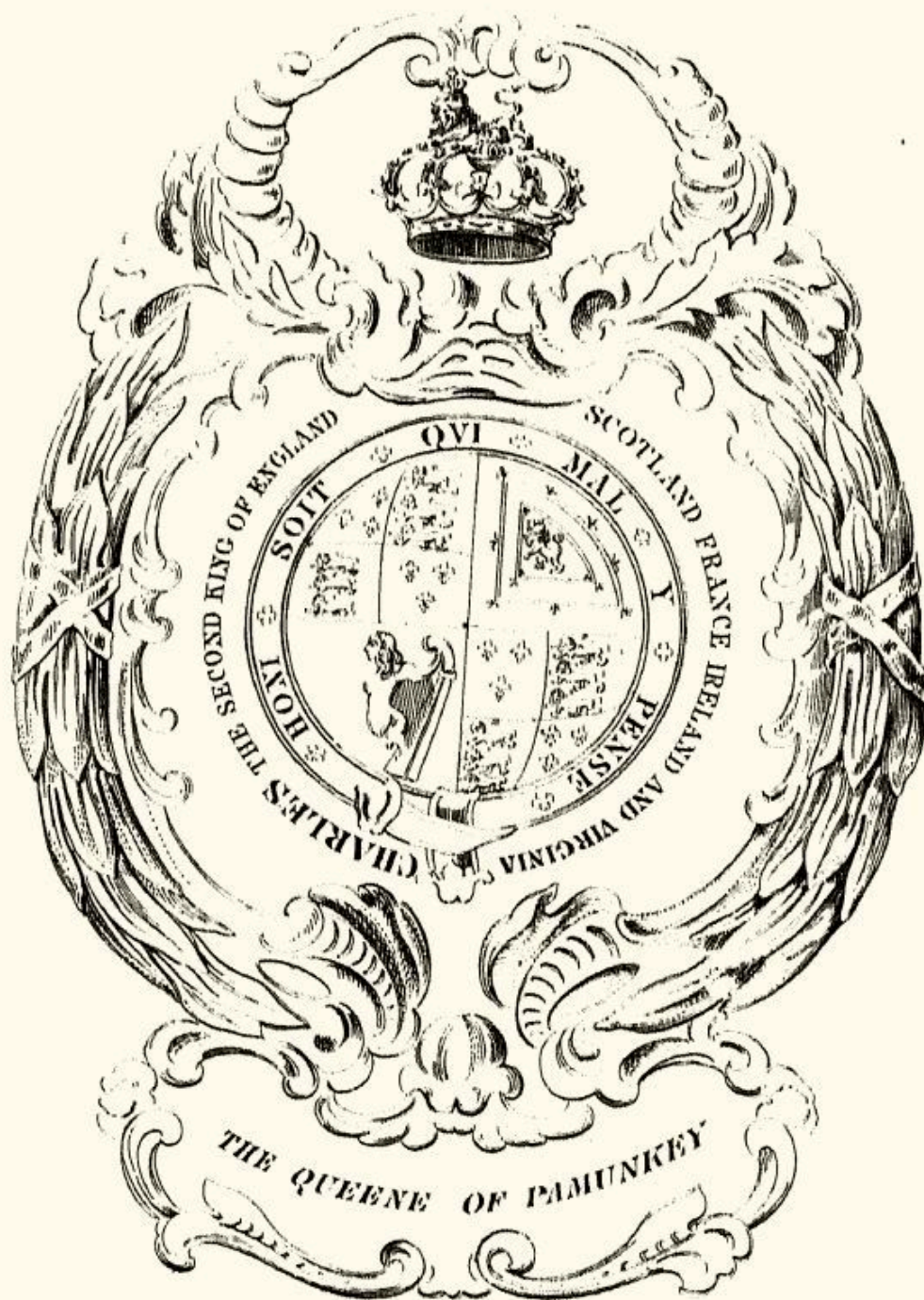
London, Printed by Tho. Newcomb for The John-
son at the sign of the Key in St. Pauls Churchyard,
near the West-end. 1658



*Your fords signs most
Gentle off in mind*

J. Milton

Enlarge



Silver Plate presented by King Charles the Second
to The Queen of Pamunkey.

Dear Sir

Washington Feb. 28. 1802.

In a letter from Despont de Nemours to me is the following passage.
 'Houdon a laisse' en Amerique un tres beau buste de Benjamin Franklin, lequel est
 actuellement chez moi. ce buste en marbre vaut cent louis de notre monnaie, environ
 400 D. rien n'est plus convenable a la nation que de le placer dans votre Capitol.
 et Houdon, au qui la Virginia doit encore mille ecus sur la statue de Washington, est
dans un ventable besoin d'argent. if the bust could be placed in our ca-
 pitol as the 'pendant' to La Fayette, it would be well. in the latter branch
 of the question I feel a personal interest, as having been the instrument
 of the contract of the state. but I imagine this matter must hang on some dif-
 ficulty of which I am uninformed I thought it not amiss to quote to you
 both parts of the paragraph as the only person who could act on both subjects
 the first question on the judiciary bill in the H. of R. and which will decide
 it's fate, it is thought will not be taken till the day after tomorrow
 Accept assurances of my affectionate esteem & respect.

Gov^r Monroe.

J. Jefferson

General Montgomery's compliments to
 Colonel Plinton & has the pleasure of con-
 -gratulating him on the Capitulation's being
 signed - at 5 o'clock the Garrison will
 march out & embark -

The Colonel will be so good as to have the
 Battery levelled when he sees our troops
 march in - & get his guns down to the
 water side for embarkation -

Nov^r 2? 1/2 after tea

Enlarge

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JOHN JAY SMITH,
MEMBER OF THE HISTORICAL SOCIETY OF PENNSYLVANIA, ETC.

SECOND SERIES—COMPLETE IN ITSELF.

NEW YORK:
CHARLES B. RICHARDSON.
1860.

[back](#)

PREFACE.

THE First Series of "American Historical and Literary Curiosities," by John F. Watson, Esq. and myself, was commenced privately as a means of preserving many documents in the possession of our friends and ourselves; but they soon increased to such importance by contributions, that it was determined to publish them. Five editions were demanded by the public at home and abroad, and the work is now scarce and high-priced. The plates being worn out, no other edition of it is likely soon, if ever, to be issued.

This Second Series, complete in itself, owes its origin to the Commercial Panic, when it was desirable to employ several artists in want of work. It has been carried through by the assistance and contributions of various friends. I am particularly indebted to Ferdinand J. Dreer, Esq., Peter Force, Esq., Lewis J. Cist, Esq., Frank M. Etting, Esq., J. Wingate Thornton, Esq., Hon. George Folsom, Herman and Caleb Cope, Esqs., J. Francis Fisher, Esq., John Macalester, Esq., Charles J. Wister, Esq., Winthrop Sargent, Esq., Bushrod W. Adams, Esq. and others, and to the Philadelphia Library for the rare Broad-sides of the Revolution, and the Historical Society of Pennsylvania, whose valuable collections have been opened to my use in the handsomest and most liberal manner.

It may be proper to copy here a portion of the Preface to the fifth edition of the First Series, explanatory of the object of the work:—

"The past has a charm for Americans, as well as for the inhabitants of countries whose history extends far into the shadowy and unknown. *Our* early and romantic past has the merit of being known and truly related. Every thing which adds to these truths is sought for with avidity by the curious and intelligent inquirer. We have now many autograph-collectors, who may be viewed in the light of preservers of documents which would otherwise perish or be dispersed. To few, comparatively, are their treasures revealed. It was suggested, therefore, that some of the most rare 'Historical and Literary Curiosities' in the possession of individuals, should be grouped for the amusement and instruction of the present and of future generations, who may well know from printed accounts *what* things were done, but who can also thus learn *how* they were done."

As in the First Series, nearly all the articles in the present collection have been taken by competent artists from the originals of which they purport to be fac-similes. Considerable labor and trouble have been expended in collecting together and adapting the varied materials here presented, but I have been rewarded by the pleasure of the pursuit.

JOHN JAY SMITH.

* * Fully to understand the work, it is necessary, in turning over the pages, to have constant reference to the Tables of Contents, where will be found many explanations for which there was not space on the plates.



Dear Sir

having perused your letter intended
for our President. I will sign the
recommendation which you propose after
you have obtained a few signatures

your mo: obedient
Stephⁿ Girard

Mr^r Will^m Israel

14th Feb^y 1809

[back](#)

I would afford no particular
pleasure my dear Mrs. Carr to pay to morrow
evening with you but we were previously
engaged at the President's to a party given
the fair Brides among whose attendants
is my niece.

Yours affectionate friend
D. P. Madison

Yours affectionate friend
D. L. Madison.

June 10th 1942.

PLXXXV.

It is Medicine with the knowledge
of the Secretary of State
in cases connected by the
Bachman & Jackson Papers —
The American Legation at its being placed
at Havana power of Police
agents of the British Police
in Birmingham Dec-5-1849

Social Notes to & from Mrs Madison,
during her Residence in Washington.

Mr de Notman requests the favour
of Mrs. Goodland writing
to Goodland -
at 8 Black.

The Sisters of the Visitation respectfully
invite Mrs. Madison to attend the
annual distribution of premiums at
their Academy Subject to 4 o'clock
Georgetown

Madame Madison
l'honneur de proposer la fin de la guerre
Jeudi 24. Ulster 1839

Mr. Webster
asks the favor of
Mrs. Madison's
company at Breakfast,
on Thursday, at 10 o'clock.
President's Square,
April 5. 1842.

1839
Mr Madison has
accepted the
invitation of Mr & Mrs Webster
to dinner on Thursday next.
March 5. 42.

Mr Adams requests the pleasure of Mrs
Madison and Miss Paine's company on
Thursday evening Feb. 5th at 8 1/2 o'clock
Thursday 29 Jan.

[back](#)

To Mrs E. A. Clark

Accept my best thanks dear Cousin for the highly valued lock of hair once worn by my Mother's friend — the lady whose name she gave me — I called to see you yesterday when I was charged with an invitation from my amiable neighbors Mrs. Ogle Taylor to your mother, myself and sweet sisters, to visit her in a social way, the first evening you were here engaged bringing with you the Beards where society you prefer — I am interested in the acceptance of this invitation as I should have the pleasure then to visit you affectionately yours.
16th Feb 42

Mrs Madison's best respects to the President and would gladly take advantage of his polite invitation to witness the curious experiment of Mr. Bell but for a headache which would disqualify her from enjoying the noise — She hopes however that it will be pleasant and safe for the President and his daughter —

Aug. 20th 42.

Prof. Pagan regrets that it will not be in his power to accept the President's kind invitation for this evening — to witness the sublimation experiment.

I am proud of your invitation conveyed in such kind words, my dear Miss Van Delft, but a promise to Mrs Newman for this evening two days ago must delay my chance of finding you and yours in such social mood — which get the beams of our new moon still dance from wave to wave — I was not at the President's yesterday, having gone to dine with the Mayor & Lady — and the admiral's son — and his — whose visit to me this morn'g (how your affectionate friend protracted my evening) as you
March 16th 42.

I am greatly mortified my dear Cousin at not having the gratification of seeing you and your sweet daughter when you were so good as to call — Will you not console and indemnify me by coming to dine with us on next, bringing with you my natural friend your husband and your daughters, to whom I promise fine music.
Affectionately yours
D. P. Madison

[back](#)

C. Street
Monday Morn

My Dear Madam,

Mr. Frederick Peel,
a Son of Sir Robert,
desires to visit Mount
Abernon.

Will you do me the
favor to give him a
note, which will secure
him a favorable admis-
sion?

I hope to be able
to introduce Mr. Peel
to you personally before
he leaves the City.

Meantime, I am
With the greatest
respect,

Very faithfully,
Yours

Robt. C. Winthrop

Mrs. Madison,

P.S. I had written & sent
a similar note to you this
morning, & the servant has
just now informed me
that it was mislaid.
This will explain the
matter, & sends you a
duplicate.

Social Notes to & from Mrs. Madison,
during her Residence in Washington.

(Copy)

You will permit me
dear Mrs. Washington, to present
to you Mr. Frederick Peel, the
son of Sir Robert - a gentleman
well known & highly respected
by our Countrymen & all others
acquainted with his brilliant
character.

Mr. Peel desires to see
the home of your ancestor,
and perhaps to view the
tomb of "the Father of his Country".
Any civilities you may have
the goodness to show him to the
end, will greatly oblige
your friends of Washington.

Affectionately yours

July 3rd 48 (signed) D. D. Madison

Enclosed to the Hon. Robt. C. Winthrop
with Mrs. Madison's best respects

Monsieur & Madame Calderon
de la Barca request the Honor of
Mrs. Madison and Miss Haynes
Company on Wednesday Evg. at
1/2 past 6 o'clock to be present at the
Baptism of Mr & Mrs. Jacob's
baby.

Saturday 19th Jan'y

[back](#)

NEVVES
Of Sr. Walter Rauleigh.

WITH
The true Description of GVIANA:

As also a Relation of the excellent Gouvernment, and
much hope of the prosperity of the Voyage.

*Sent from a Gentleman of his Fleet, to a most
especiall Friend of his in London.*

From the River of Caliana, on the Coast of Guiana, Novemb. 17. 1617.



LONDON.
Printed for H. C. and are to be sold by J. Wright, at the signe of the
Bible without New-gate. 1618.

The Cabinet-Council.
Containing the Cheif ARTS
OF
EMPIRE,
And MYSTERIES of
STATE;
DISCABINETED
In Political. and Polemical Aphorisms,
grounded on Authority, and Experience;
And illustrated with the choicest
Examples and Historical
Observations.

By the Ever-renowned Knight,
Sir WALTER RALEIGH,
Published
By JOHN MILTON, Esq;

Quis Martem iustas res illam Adamantini digni scriptoris?

London, Printed by Tho. Newcombe for The. Johnson at the sign of the Key in St. Pauls Churchyard,
near the West-end. 1658



*Your Lordships most
Obedient and in duty
bound*

W. Raleigh

[back](#)

Dear Sir

Washington Feb. 28. 1802.

In a letter from Despont de Nemours to me is the following passage.
 'Houdon a laisse' en Amerique un tres beau buste de Benjamin Franklin, lequel est
 actuellement chez moi. ce buste en marbre vaut cent louis de notre monnaie, environ
 400. D. rien n'est plus convenable a la nation que de le placer dans votre Capito-
 le et Houdon, a qui la Virginia doit encore mille ecus sur la statue de Washington, est
 dans un ventable besoin d'argent.' if the bust could be placed in our ca-
 pitol as the 'pendant' to La Fayette, it would be well. in the latter branch
 of the question I feel a personal interest, as having been the instrument
 of the contract of the State. but I imagine this matter must hang on some dif-
 ficulty of which I am uninformed I thought it not amiss to quote to you
 both parts of the paragraph as the only person who could act on both subjects
 the first question on the judiciary bill in the H. of R. and which will decide
 it's fate, it is thought will not be taken till the day after tomorrow
 Accept assurances of my affectionate esteem & respect.

Gov^r Monroe.

J. Jefferson

General Montgomery's compliments to
 Colonel Plinton & has the pleasure of con-
 -gratulating him on the Capitulation's being
 signed - at 5 o'clock the Garrison will
 march out & embark -

The Colonel will be so good as to have the
 Battery levelled when he sees our troops
 march in - & get his guns down to the
 water side for embarkation -

Nov^r 2? 1/2 after tea

[back](#)